

Interview Preparation Guide — Frontend Developer

1. Core JavaScript & TypeScript

Frontend interviews commonly test closures, the event loop and async execution (promises, async/await, microtasks vs. macrotasks), prototypal inheritance, and hoisting, along with var/let/const differences.

For TypeScript-heavy roles, expect questions on structural typing, generics, and utility types (Partial, Pick, Omit).

2. Framework Knowledge (React is most common)

Deep questions on hooks (useState, useEffect dependency arrays and cleanup, useMemo/useCallback), reconciliation/virtual DOM diffing, and when to use Context API versus a dedicated state library.

3. CSS and Layout

Live layout tasks using Flexbox/Grid, plus conceptual questions on the box model, specificity, and responsive design (media queries vs. container queries).

4. Performance and Web Fundamentals

Lazy loading/code-splitting, image optimization, Core Web Vitals (LCP, CLS, INP), and the browser rendering pipeline (parse, style, layout, paint, composite).

Scenario-Based Questions

Scenario-based questions test applied judgment rather than textbook recall — interviewers are usually more interested in your reasoning process than the exact final answer.

Scenario: A user reports that a page 'freezes' for a second every time they type in a search box that filters a large list. How would you diagnose and fix this?

Scenario: Your team's bundle size has grown 40% over two months and page load times are creeping up. Walk through how you'd investigate and reduce it.

Scenario: A component re-renders far more often than expected, causing visible lag on a data-heavy dashboard. How do you find the cause?

Questions by Experience Level

The bar for the same topic area rises sharply by level. Below is a representative question for a Frontend Developer at each tier, showing how depth of expected answer changes — not just difficulty of the question itself.

Intern: Q: What's the difference between let, const, and var?

Entry-Level: Q: Explain how useEffect's dependency array affects when it runs.

Associate Engineer: Q: How would you prevent unnecessary re-renders in a list of 1,000 items?

Engineer: Q: Design the component structure and state flow for a multi-step checkout form.

Senior: Q: How would you establish a shared design-system and enforce consistency across five different team codebases?

Principal: Q: How would you decide whether to adopt a new frontend framework/meta-framework org-wide, and what migration strategy would you propose for dozens of existing apps?